



What's It To Me?

Politics, in your context.

FUNDERS AND PARTNERS EDITION

Impartial by *design*, sourced by default.

How What's It To Me? shows every voter who is on their ballot and what each candidate has published, without ever telling them what to think, and how anyone can check every word.

Edition

September 2026 (v1.1)
Figures as at 25 September 2026

Founders

Romily Johnson, Founder and Product
Lead
Barry Trevelyan-Johnson, Technical
Lead

Contact

hello@whatsittome.org
whatsittome.org

The question people actually ask

Not who is winning, but what would this mean for me, for my household, for my street. Most political coverage answers a different question.

What's It To Me? began as an idea of Romily Johnson's, a student: an informed electorate makes better decisions, and the way to inform it is to connect politics to a person's own life without telling them how to vote.

Manifestos are written for everyone, and so for no one in particular. Campaigns talk in national averages. The gap between that and an ordinary life is where many people give up. The site closes the gap with a postcode and a few optional facts about a household.

It is a non-partisan, not-for-profit UK voter-information site. It takes no advertising and no money from any party, candidate or campaign, and neither founder is a member of, works for, or is paid by any party or campaign.

"So the name is the question, asked plainly."

whatsittome.org, "Who we are"

WHAT IT WILL NEVER DO

Rank, score, match or recommend. The site shows who is standing, what each has published, and where it touches the reader's life. The judgement stays with the voter.

25

elections still to come this autumn, all on file

109

candidates standing in them, each shown on an identical page

376

published positions, each quoted from its source

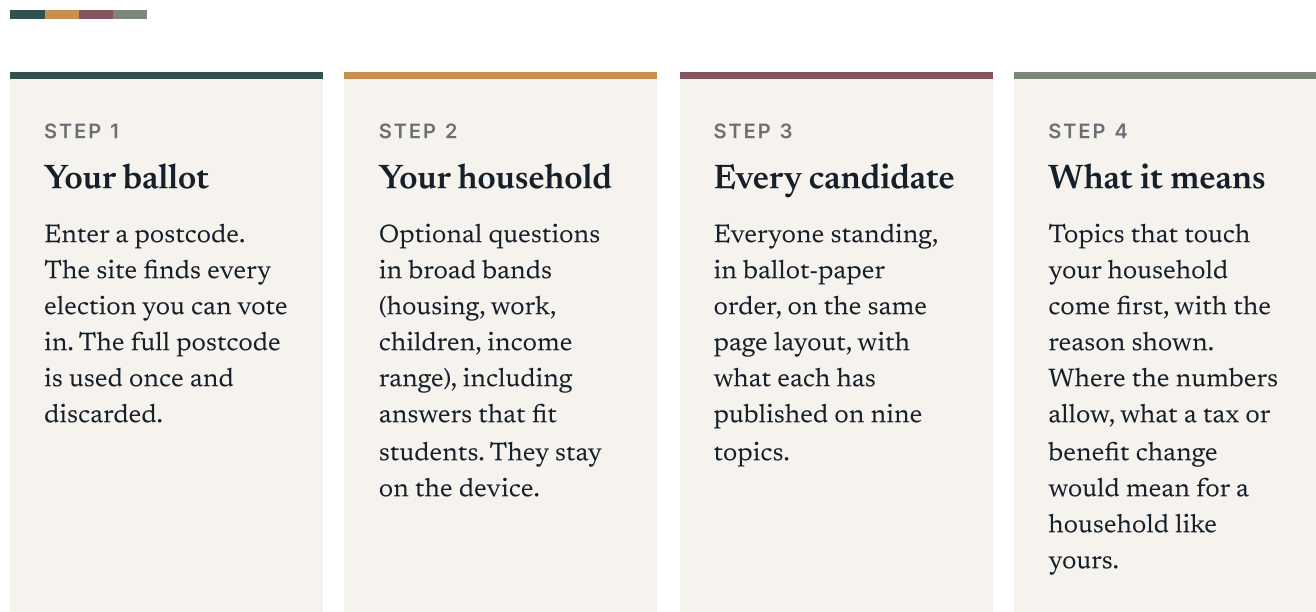
91

named, dated, linked sources

Counts read from the live database on 25 September 2026. They change as elections are added and archived.

What a voter sees

Four steps from a postcode to an informed choice, on a phone, in a few minutes.



Nine topics

Money and cost of living · housing · health and social care · education · environment and energy · immigration and borders · crime, policing and justice · defence, foreign affairs and the EU · equality and rights.

Beyond the ballot

For every postcode, even without an election: when you next vote, who represents you at every level (council, mayor, devolved parliament, Westminster), and which unelected bodies also run things locally. For 29 councils, a page on what the council has published on housing, transport, council tax, the environment and schools, and what it is deciding at its meetings.

Practical help to vote

Registration, postal and proxy deadlines, the free Voter Authority Certificate, accepted photo ID, and where to vote. A printable notes sheet to take to the polling station.

Built for everyone

Light and dark themes, adjustable text size, high contrast, a plain-English mode, read-aloud, and a light version for slow connections. Pages are checked at phone width, with enlarged text, and with an automated accessibility checker.

Neutral by design, not by promise

Romily’s founding requirements were that the site be completely impartial, attribute every fact to its source, leave no way for figures to be manipulated, and give no grounds to say it prefers any candidate. Each became a rule the software enforces.



SAFEGUARD	HOW IT WORKS
One template for everyone	Every candidate gets the same page, the same sections in the same place, in ballot-paper order. There is no other ordering anywhere on the site.
No record is not a mark against	A newcomer without a voting record gets the same neutral line as anyone else: “Has not held this office before, so there is no voting record to show.” Party positions are the layer everyone has.
Quotation, not interpretation	Every position is the source’s own words, with publisher, date and link. A short plain-English summary sits underneath as a reading aid, using neutral verbs (“says”, “pledged”).
Vague promises are labelled	If a pledge has no number, date or concrete object, it is shown as “Stated aim, no measurable commitment found”, the same way for every party.
Neutral colour	The interface is neutral. A party’s colour appears only on its own panel. Money figures never use green or red.
No AI at the point of use	No AI system runs when a visitor uses the site. AI helps draft summaries behind the scenes; every quotation is checked word for word against its source before publication, and the record shows what was drafted with AI help.
Nothing ever silently changes	Positions are held in an append-only ledger. A correction is a new entry that points at the old one; nothing is edited or deleted, and the database refuses any attempt.

The never-build list

Features that would turn information into advice. They are refused however useful they might look.

Match percentages or “agreement” scores	Favourites, hearts or saved shortlists	Sorting by anything but the ballot paper
“Recommended for you” or “people like you chose”	Left/right axes or ideology quizzes	Weighting by incumbency, polls or past results

Where every fact comes from

The primary source first: the party’s or candidate’s own publication, the official record, the statute. Press reports are used only as a flagged stopgap until the primary is found.

376 positions, by source

SOURCE LAYER	POSITIONS
Party publications and manifestos	293
Candidates’ own statements	73
Enacted record	9
Independent analysis	1

Each kind carries a grey label of identical weight. Where candidate statements or leaflets appear, the page says: we check they are real, not that they are true.

The site’s own text, claims and ledger are published under CC BY-SA 4.0; the code is open source under the AGPL-3.0.

Anyone can check the record

- **The public ledger** lists every live position and every change, with who made it, when and why.
- **A fingerprint before polling day.** The full ledger is published with a SHA-256 checksum and archived, so anyone can confirm later that nothing was altered.
- **Every source is re-read every week.** Each quotation is checked to still be there word for word, and an independent Internet Archive copy is linked beside it. The first pass led to 24 claims being re-linked to where the words actually are.
- **Complaints are logged publicly**, with their outcome.
- **Coverage is shown, not hidden.** A coverage page counts how much sourced material was found for each party on each topic, and says plainly that it measures what was found, not quality.

Open data the site is built on

SOURCE	USED FOR	TERMS
Democracy Club	Elections, candidates and their statements	CC BY 4.0
UK Parliament	MPs, Commons votes, Hansard, registers of interests, petitions	Open Parliament Licence
ONS, MHCLG, Land Registry, police.uk, planning.data.gov.uk	Boundaries, deprivation, council tax, house prices, crime, planning	Open Government Licence
Electoral Commission	Party registrations and donations	Public register
Open Council Data	Councillors and council control	Public domain
Councils’ own papers	Council plans, budgets, decisions, motions	Quoted and linked
PolicyEngine UK	Tax-and-benefit calculations	Open source

What it could mean for a household

Where a party's tax or benefit promise is specific enough to model, the site shows what it would change for a household like the reader's, with every assumption stated.



8,100

household types, from combinations of age, income, household, children, housing and work

40,500

results computed in advance with PolicyEngine UK, an open-source model of the UK tax and benefit system

0

calculations done live: every figure is a stored, reproducible result

Computing everything in advance means every figure can be checked and reproduced, and the model version is stored with each result. The assumptions (band midpoints, representative ages and rents, who claims which benefits) are listed next to every calculation.

Only promises with a concrete number are modelled. Three party policies are modelled so far, alongside current law.

STATED LIMITS

The model currently uses London assumptions, because the first election covered is in London; it will be extended before money figures are shown elsewhere. Student finance sits outside the tax-and-benefit model and is not included.

Privacy, in one paragraph

The postcode is sent once, used to find the ballot and discarded; only the first half travels further, to place an approximate circle on a map. Household answers are broad bands and stay on the visitor's device. The site keeps anonymous daily page counts per election and nothing else: no IP addresses, no tracking cookies, no per-visitor records.

Where it stands

The site is live at whatsittome.org. Its first real test is a parliamentary by-election in central London.



FIRST LIVE TEST: 8 OCTOBER 2026

The **Holborn and St Pancras by-election**. 15 candidates, each on the same page, with 268 sourced positions attached to the ballot. Every candidate’s party has sourced positions on file except two, the Communist League and one candidate whose websites have no text that can be quoted; the coverage page shows this openly.

THIS AUTUMN’S COUNCIL BY-ELECTIONS

24 council by-elections still to come across England, Scotland and Wales, polling between 1 and 29 October, each with its candidates and their statements, and the council’s own page where one exists.

29

council pages, each quoting the council’s own papers

13

councils whose meeting agendas load automatically every week

19,273

serving councillors from 384 councils

10

research papers behind the design decisions

What comes next

Late September	The site goes round for feedback; a social media account follows.
8 October 2026	Holborn and St Pancras by-election: the first live test.
May 2027	The local elections, the first large-scale use.
Planned	iOS and Google Play apps; a Welsh-language version; candidates submitting their own sourced statements through an invitation portal (already built); council motion results alongside the motions.

Technology, governance and cost

Deliberately simple, open and cheap to run, so that the site can outlast any one election.

Technology

A server-rendered web application (Next.js) hosted on Netlify, one Postgres database (Supabase, hosted in London), and scheduled jobs in GitHub that refresh elections, schools and consultations daily, and council meetings, planning, party funding and every quoted source weekly. Each run is logged publicly on the site's status page. Where a site blocks automated reading, it is checked by hand, so no party is watched less closely than another. Maps use OpenStreetMap. The code is open source under the AGPL-3.0.

Governance

Romily Johnson, Founder and Product Lead, owns the project and makes decisions on direction. **Barny Trevelyan-Johnson**, Technical Lead, builds and runs it. Decisions are recorded with a date and the person who made them. Corrections and withdrawals are made by a named maintainer and logged publicly with the reason.

Running costs

The site is self-funded. It currently runs on a shared hosting plan (\$9 a month, shared with other sites) and a free database tier. The shared hosting allowance has run out every month since June, and briefly took the site offline on 24 September. Dedicated hosting before polling days is the most immediate practical need.

Independence

The site takes no advertising and no money from any party, candidate or campaign. Its rules on what is shown are written into the software and published, so they do not depend on who pays for it.

Where partners could help

HOSTING AND RUNNING COSTS

Dedicated hosting with headroom for polling-day traffic, so the site cannot be suspended by other sites' usage.

DATA PARTNERS

Democracy Club, which already supplies candidate data: a candidates-API token, higher request limits for polling day, and clarity on candidate photo licences.

WELSH TRANSLATION

A translator for a full Welsh-language version before Welsh elections.

TESTING AND FEEDBACK

Schools, colleges, libraries and community groups to try the site with first-time voters and tell us where it falls short.